

**TCC103 (IT FUNDAMENTALS)**  
**Week III Assignment**

M1U4\_U5 Prelims Assignment 3

Subject Code-Section: ITCC103-102I

Date: August 8, 2026

**Questions:**

1. Based on the different methods for installing applications in Windows 11, such as the Microsoft Store and traditional desktop installers, what are the advantages and disadvantages of each method? In what scenario might a user prefer one over the other?

**Answer:** Microsoft Store has automatic updates, is secure and easy to install/uninstall, but limited app selection. Traditional installers have wider software availability, more customization/control, but risk of malware, manual updates. Store for casual/security-conscious users and in traditional installers for professional or specialized software not on the Store.

2. Explain the purpose of the Task Manager. How can a user utilize Task Manager to troubleshoot a computer that is running slowly or an application that is not responding?

**Answer:** Task Manager shows running processes, resource usage (CPU, RAM, disk, network), and startup programs. For a slow PC, check the Performance/Processes tab to find resource-heavy programs and close them. For a frozen app, select it under Processes and click "End Task" to force-close it without restarting the whole system.

3. Our lesson discusses different types of storage devices, including HDDs, SSDs, and cloud storage. What are the key differences between these storage types in terms of performance and reliability? Which type of storage would you recommend for a primary drive on a new computer and why?

**Answer:** HDD are cheaper, larger capacity, slower, more prone to mechanical failure. SSD are much faster, more reliable (no moving parts), but pricier per GB. And Cloud storage, accessible anywhere, good for backup/sharing, but depends on internet and ongoing subscription cost. Recommend SSD as primary drive for speed and reliability in daily use.

4. Why is it important to keep the operating system and applications updated? Describe a potential security or performance risk a user might face if they consistently ignore system and application updates.

**Answer:** Updates patch security vulnerabilities and fix bugs/performance issues. Risk of ignoring them, exposure to malware/hacking through vulnerabilities, or continued slowdowns/crashes from unresolved bugs.

5. Based on the best practices for file management, what is the importance of creating a logical folder structure and regularly backing up data? Describe a personal or hypothetical experience where following these practices could prevent a significant loss of information.

**Answer:** A logical folder structure makes files easy to find and reduces duplication. Regular backups protect against data loss from crashes, deletion, or malware. Like this, if a laptop crashes and files were backed up to cloud storage beforehand, important documents can be recovered instead of lost permanently.

6. Our lesson differentiates between the cause, symptom, and consequence of a problem. Choose a common computer issue, such as a slow internet connection or a program that keeps crashing, and explain the difference between the cause, symptom, and consequence in that specific context.

**Answer:** For example of this is a slow internet connections, the cause of this is too many devices/apps using bandwidth, symptom is pages load slowly, videos buffer and last the consequence of this is missed deadlines, poor video call quality, frustration.

7. Our lesson outlines several basic troubleshooting steps, including rebooting and checking connection. Describe a time you experienced a computer or device problem and how you used these basic steps (or others) to try and solve it. Did you succeed, and if not, what do you think the next step would have been?

**Answer:** For instance of basic troubleshooting. Wi-Fi wasn't connecting on a laptop. Steps tried: restarted the router, checked if Wi-Fi was toggled on, reconnected to the network. It worked after restarting the router. If it hadn't, the next step would be checking network drivers or contacting the ISP.

8. Our lesson suggests using different sources for technical support, such as built-in help, technical communities, and search engines. Which of these resources do you think is most effective for a beginner, and why? What are the potential drawbacks of relying on community groups for help?

**Answer:** For a beginner, built-in help/official documentation is often most effective. It's accurate, specific to the product, and safe. Community groups can help but carry drawbacks: advice may be outdated, incorrect, or hard for a beginner to evaluate/trust.

9. Our lesson provides tips for optimizing search queries. Imagine you are experiencing a "blue screen" error on your Windows 11 computer with a specific error code. Formulate a search query you would use to find a solution, and explain why each part of your query is important.

**Answer:** Search "windows 11 blue screen error 0x0000007B fix", it'll show you how to update or correct your OS version, shows the specific error code in the issue instead of giving info about the BSOD.

10. Based on the principle that "resolving the consequences is often the priority" from a business perspective, explain why a company might prioritize a quick, temporary fix over a more time-consuming, permanent solution for a technical problem. What are the potential long-term risks of this approach?

**Answer:** Businesses often prioritize a quick, temporary fix to minimize downtime, keep operations running, and satisfy customers/deadlines immediately. Long-term risks: the underlying problem persists and may worsen, leading to repeated failures, higher costs, and potential bigger outages later if the root cause is never properly addressed.